

Usability Testing Plan

Forecasting & Planning Tool Prototype

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Pre-Testing Setup

Test Tasks

Task 1: Initial Exploration

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Task: "Spend a couple of minutes exploring what you see here. Walk me through what catches your attention and what you think this tool is for."

What to Observe:

- What do they notice first?
- How do they describe the interface?
- What terminology do they use?
- Do they understand the data structure?
- What questions do they have?
- What seems intuitive or confusing?

Success Criteria: User can describe the tool's purpose and basic structure

Task 2: Data Organization

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Task: "Look at how the data is organized. What do you notice about the rows and columns? How are they related to each other?"

What to Observe:

- Do they notice hierarchical relationships?
- Do they understand parent/child relationships?
- Can they identify measures, dimensions, and time periods?
- Do they notice expand/collapse functionality?
- How do they describe the organization?

Success Criteria: User recognizes hierarchical structure and data relationships

Task 3: Changing the View

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Task: "Suppose you wanted to see this same data organized differently - maybe with rows and columns swapped, or showing different levels of detail. How would you go about that?"

What to Observe:

- Where do they look for view options?
- Do they discover layout switching?
- Do they find dimension/time granularity controls?
- Can they change what's visible?
- Do they understand the layout notation?

Success Criteria: User discovers customization options

Task 4: Toolbar Exploration

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Task: "Look at the toolbar area. What do you think each of those icons and controls does? Feel free to click around and explore."

What to Observe:

- Which controls do they notice?
- What do they think each icon does?
- Do they try clicking them?
- What panels or features open?
- Do they understand the search functionality?
- Are controls discoverable?

Success Criteria: User explores toolbar and discovers key functions

Task 5: Modifying Values

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Task: "Imagine you need to update a forecast number. How would you go about changing it? What do you think will happen when you do?"

What to Observe:

- How do they approach editing?
- What interactions do they try?
- Do they discover editing capability?
- What visual feedback appears?
- Do they understand how to save?
- What happens after editing?

Success Criteria: User discovers editing and understands the workflow

Task 6: Understanding Changes

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Task: "After you change a value, look around the grid. What else changed? Why do you think that happened?"

What to Observe:

- Do they notice related values updated?
- Do they understand propagation?
- What visual indicators do they notice?
- Do they see different cell states (edited vs impacted)?
- Can they explain the relationships?

Success Criteria: User recognizes automatic value updates and understands propagation

Task 7: Finding Specific Information

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Task: "You need to find data for a particular product or a specific month. How would you locate that?"

What to Observe:

- How do they approach finding data?
- Do they discover search functionality?
- Do they find filtering options?
- What search terms do they try?
- Is highlighting helpful?
- Which method do they prefer?

Success Criteria: User discovers search or filtering functionality

Task 8: Adding Context

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Task: "You want to document why you made a particular change. How would you add that information?"

What to Observe:

- How do they try to add documentation?
- When do they discover note functionality?
- What interaction reveals notes?
- Can they add a note successfully?
- Do they see note indicators on cells?
- Is the workflow intuitive?

Success Criteria: User discovers and uses note functionality

Task 9: Tracking History

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Task: "You want to see what changes have been made to a cell and who made them. How would you find that information?"

What to Observe:

- Where do they look for history?
- What actions do they try?
- Do they discover the cell details panel?
- What information is displayed?
- Can they understand the history entries?
- Is the information useful?

Success Criteria: User finds and understands edit history

Task 10: Collaborating

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Task: "You want to discuss a change with your team. How would you add a comment or start a discussion?"

What to Observe:

- How do they try to add comments?
- Do they discover discussion features?
- Where do they look?
- Can they add comments successfully?
- Do they see existing discussions?
- Is the collaboration feature discoverable?

Success Criteria: User discovers and uses comment/discussion functionality

Task 11: Protecting Data

Task 11: Protecting Data

Task: "You want to make sure a certain value doesn't get accidentally changed. How would you protect it?"

What to Observe:

- How do they try to protect cells?
- Do they discover locking functionality?
- Where do they look?
- Do they try right-click menu?
- What visual indicator appears?
- Can they verify it's protected?

Success Criteria: User discovers cell locking functionality

Task 12: Reversing Actions

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Task: "You just made a change but realize it was wrong. How would you undo it?"

What to Observe:

- How do they try to undo?
- Where do they look for undo?
- Do they discover undo functionality?
- Does it work as expected?
- Do they find redo?
- Is the functionality discoverable?

Success Criteria: User discovers undo/redo functionality

Task 13: Saving Work

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Task: "You've made several changes. How do you save them? What if you decide you don't want to keep these changes?"

What to Observe:

- Where do they look for save?
- Do they understand draft vs saved state?
- How do they discard changes?
- Is the workflow clear?
- What happens when they save/cancel?

Success Criteria: User finds save and cancel functionality

Task 14: Visual Cues

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Task: "Look at the different cells in the grid. What visual differences do you notice? What do you think those differences mean?"

What to Observe:

- What visual indicators do they notice?
- Do they see color differences?
- Do they notice arrows, icons, or symbols?
- What do they think indicators mean?
- Are readonly cells visually distinct?
- Is the visual language clear?

Success Criteria: User notices and interprets visual indicators

Task 15: Filtering Views

Task 15: Filtering Views

Task: "You only want to see certain types of data - maybe just the rows or columns that were affected by changes. How would you filter the view?"

What to Observe:

- How do they try to filter?
- Do they discover impacted measures filter?
- Where do they look?
- What happens when they enable filtering?
- Do they understand what "impacted" means?
- Is the filtered view useful?

Success Criteria: User discovers filtering options

Task 16: Cell Information

Task 16: Cell Information

Task: "You want to know more about a specific cell - maybe who last changed it, when, or what it represents. How would you get that information?"

What to Observe:

- What actions do they try?
- Do they discover the info popover?
- Do they find the cell details panel?
- What information is shown?
- Can they access dimension hierarchy?
- Is the information discoverable?

Success Criteria: User finds cell information display

Task 17: Overall Exploration

Task 17: Overall Exploration

Task: "Take a few minutes to explore anything that interests you. What features did you discover? What surprised you? What would you want to use in your daily work?"

What to Observe:

- What features do they discover on their own?
- What surprises them?
- What features do they find useful?
- What features do they miss?
- What would they want to use?
- What seems unnecessary?

Success Criteria: User discovers additional features through exploration

Experience Rating Questions

After completing the exploration tasks, ask the following rating questions:

Rating 1: Overall Ease of Use

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very difficult and 5 is very easy, how easy was it to use this tool overall?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "What made it easy or difficult?"

Rating 2: Feature Discoverability

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very hard to find and 5 is very easy to find, how easy was it to discover features without instructions?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "Which features were easiest to find? Which were hardest?"

Rating 3: Visual Clarity

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very unclear and 5 is very clear, how clear were the visual indicators and feedback?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "Which visual cues were most helpful? Which were confusing?"

Rating 4: Value Propagation Understanding

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very confusing and 5 is very clear, how well did you understand how values update automatically?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "Was the automatic updating helpful or surprising?"

Rating 5: Layout Comprehension

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very confusing and 5 is very clear, how well did you understand the different layout options?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "Did the layout notation make sense to you?"

Rating 6: Editing Workflow

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very difficult and 5 is very easy, how easy was it to edit cells and add notes?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "What worked well? What could be improved?"

Rating 7: Search and Filtering

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is not useful and 5 is very useful, how useful did you find the search and filtering features?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "Did you find what you were looking for easily?"

Rating 8: Edit History and Collaboration

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is not useful and 5 is very useful, how useful did you find the edit history and comment features?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "Would you use these features in your daily work?"

Rating 9: Overall Satisfaction

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very dissatisfied and 5 is very satisfied, how satisfied are you with this tool overall?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "What would make you more satisfied?"

Rating 10: Likelihood to Use

Question: "On a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 is very unlikely and 5 is very likely, how likely are you to use this tool in your daily work?"

Rating: ____ / 5

Follow-up: "What would need to change for you to use it more?"

Post-Testing Questionnaire

1. **Ease of Use:** How easy was it to use the tool? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
2. **Learning Curve:** How quickly did you understand how to use it? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
3. **Visual Design:** How would you rate the visual design? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
4. **Feature Completeness:** Do you feel all necessary features are present? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
5. **Performance:** How would you rate the speed and responsiveness? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
6. **How easy was it to find features without instructions?** (1-5)
- Comments: _____
7. **Were controls where you expected them?** (1-5)
- Comments: _____
8. **Did visual cues help you discover functionality?** (1-5)
- Comments: _____
9. **Cell Editing:** How useful is the editing functionality? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
10. **Value Propagation:** How useful is automatic value updating? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
11. **Search Functionality:** How useful is the search feature? (1-5)
- Comments: _____
12. **Adjustment Notes:** How useful is adding notes to cells? (1-5)
- Comments: _____

13. **Edit History:** How useful is viewing change history? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

14. **Cell Locking:** How useful is locking cells? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

15. **Layout Switching:** How useful is changing grid layouts? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

16. **Grid Structure:** How well did you understand the grid structure? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

17. **Data Relationships:** How clear were parent/child relationships? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

18. **Value Propagation:** How well did you understand automatic updates? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

19. **Visual Indicators:** How well did you understand visual feedback? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

20. **Layout Notation:** How well did you understand what "Measures / Dimensions x Time" means? (1-5)

- Comments: _____

21. **What did you like most about the tool?**

- _____

22. **What features were difficult to discover?**

- _____

23. **What features were easy to discover?**

- _____

24. **What did you find confusing or unclear?**

- _____

25. **What features did you find most useful?**

- _____

26. **What features did you find least useful?**

- _____

27. **What features are missing that you would need?**

- _____

28. **What would you change to make features more discoverable?**

- _____

29. **What visual indicators were most helpful?**

- _____

30. **What visual indicators were confusing or unclear?**

- _____

31. **How did you interpret the layout notation (Measures / Dimensions x Time)?**

- _____

32. **Where did you expect to find controls for changing the grid layout?**

- _____

33. **What surprised you about the tool?**

- _____

34. **What features did you discover that you weren't expecting?**

- _____

35. **Would you use this tool in your daily work? Why or why not?**

- _____

36. **How does this compare to tools you currently use?**

- _____

37. Any other comments or suggestions?
-

Success Criteria

Testing Notes Template

Session Date: _____
Participant ID: _____
Tester Name: _____
Duration: _____
Comprehension:
Discoverability:
Usefulness:
User Quotes:
Struggles/Confusion:
Surprises/Discoveries:
Unexpected Behaviors:

Appendix: Quick Reference Checklist

End of Usability Testing Plan